

BACKGROUND

The UK market is highly competitive and as a mid-large independent agency, we need to be able to secure multi-market / global clients. This comes with a tension. Agency margins are being squeezed - and to meet client's multi-language needs effectively, we cannot deploy a headcount-first response to a language problem.

In fact, if we can "crack" the model with a peak-human mode technology solution - which manifests as a highly cost effective, high-quality translation service - we quickly become the most compelling option and it gives us the right to use competitors' reliance on headcount as weakness.

USER STORY

As a marketing professional I need to create content - which may take the form of anything from simple single line ad copy to technically complex whitepapers and research documents - in any language my business (or in our case, client) requires.

I need to trust the content's language accuracy, ensure it reflects cultural nuance and the audience language zeitgeist - with the appropriate slang or technical language - and befits the clients' brand tone of voice.

I am time poor, cost-constrained and have limited resources to employ humans in the process. A best-in-class solution would use technology to complete 95% of the work and use a local language editor to QA, confirm and polish.

THE PROJECT IN ONE LINE

To build an AI solution that translates copy into any language, taking into account local, cultural and trend-based linguistic nuance, to produce a highly accurate, natural, localised and audience-relevant output for a native speaker to review and approve with limited effort or cost.

SPECIFICATION

System:

- We may wish to have a master project that learns from human edits (and updates all derivative systems)
- Each client should be onboarded onto their own instance of the tech to allow for audience and tone of voice direction to be provided (with all languages available)
- The system should feed into an Asana project to allow editors to easily review the translated output - translated copy may wish to be inputted as an Asana task

Inputs:

- Audience insight provided

- Client direction on tone of voice provided
 - This may include documentation, examples, etc
- The copy to be translated
- The required language for the copy to be translated into
- Other document to be discussed

Outputs:

- The translated content for a human to review
- Any supporting information to help with the human review

Learning:

- The system should have a function to receive language edits and learn from them
- Overtime, the need for a human to review the content should be reduced

Watch-outs:

- Language provided in a language will need to be stripped of idioms in a step; this may include "stretch" idioms:
 - E.g., "right place, right time" > "right person, right time" = "correcto persona, correcto tiempo" which is correct, but reads unnaturally in Spanish
- We need a way to ensure nothing offensive is added to the content, even when it may be naturally used - e.g., "something great" in Spanish = "de puta madre" which may be locally valid, but is not something that most brands would want to be seen to say
- Where language is highly technical (e.g., a health-tech whitepaper), we may wish to be able to input research documents / journals as a source material